



RIGHTSIZE. RIGHT SUPPORT. **RIGHT** *for* **STUDENTS.**

A family guide to the proposed school changes

Every school is a community. A school change can affect friendships, routines, programs, and a family's sense of belonging. This guide explains what is proposed and why.

Scenarios A and B are proposals, not final decisions. "No changes proposed" means these options do not include a change for that school.

Each school has a snapshot and a box explaining the reasons for the proposal. The next page shows enrollment estimates, programs, student groups, and maps. Estimates cover 2027-28 through 2031-32. They are not current student counts.

The possible benefits are goals. A larger school does not automatically get a full-time librarian, certain staff, or specific programs. Those details depend on the district's staffing rules, budget, and plans for making the changes.

A school or program move does not determine where an individual student receiving special education services will go. Families and school teams would need to plan each student's services and support.

The school details, numbers, and maps come from PPS school profiles. This guide explains that information in simpler language.

Words you may see in this guide

No changes

What is expected if the district keeps the current schools and programs.

Option A / Option B

The two scenarios. "A and B" means the same information applies to both.

School boundary

The area used to assign students to a neighborhood school based on where they live.

School communities joining

Students from two or more schools would come together. The proposal says which school building would close.

Programs joining

A program would come together at one school or move to another school.

DLI

Dual Language Immersion: learning in English and another language.

School size goal

More than 360 students for K-5 schools; more than 500 for K-8 or middle schools; more than 1,100 for high schools. These are planning goals, not ratings of school quality.

Space use goal

The district aims to use 70%-100% of a school's available room for students. A "No" can mean the school is below or above that range.

Title I

Federal money that supports schools serving students from low-income households. The guide shows the expected designation.

IEP

An Individualized Education Program: a written plan for a student's special education services and support.

Choice program

A program with a special focus, such as arts or science. It may serve families beyond a neighborhood school boundary.

Student groups

Groups can overlap. Do not add the percentages together.

**You may notice slight differences in student numbers and/or demographics in schools that don't experience change because a focus option school has changed and we assume that students return to their neighborhood school.*

METROPOLITAN LEARNING CENTER (MLC)

School proposal | Options A and B

SCHOOL SNAPSHOT	DETAILS
Current program	K-12 alternative school
Expected enrollment with no changes	245 in 2027-28; 199 in 2031-32
District school size goal	Alternative school setting
Students living within 1 mile	Not applicable
Building notes	School space is described below.

WHY IS PPS CONSIDERING THIS?

- Matching grade structures: Changing MLC to K-8 matches district grade structures while creating space to co-locate MLC and Odyssey.
- Teaching models: Both programs center hands-on learning, allowing for the potential of shared resources.

This is a proposal, not a final decision.

What is being proposed?

Metropolitan Learning Center (MLC) would change from a K-12 to a K-8 alternative (choice) school. High school (9th-12th) students would transition to another PPS alternative school, attend a focus option or return to their designated neighborhood high schools.

The Odyssey K-8 program would co-locate onto the MLC school facility.

What could students gain?

Strong hands-on learning: Creates co-located vibrant K-8 schools centered on hands-on learning.

Neighborhood high school access: High schoolers attend their neighborhood comprehensive high school with full high school athletics, advanced placement (AP) courses, and electives.

What else was considered?

Move timing: High schoolers would move in Fall 2027, while Odyssey moves when physical site preparation at MLC is complete.

METROPOLITAN LEARNING CENTER

ENROLLMENT, PROGRAMS & MAPS

How many students are expected?

School year	2027-28	2028-29	2029-30	2030-31	2031-32
No changes	245	231	215	198	199
Scenario A/B Note: Enrollment shows Odyssey and MLC for facility purposes.	386	371	353	338	341

Programs, school size & nearby families

Measure	No changes	Options A and B
Type of change	No changes	Grade changes
Meets school size goal?	No	No
Meets space use goal?	No	Yes
Students living within 1 mile	Not applicable	Not applicable
Grades and programs	K-8 choice program	K-8 choice program

Where would the school boundary be?

This program does not have a neighborhood school boundary.

Who would the school serve?

Option	Poverty	Special education	Multilingual services	Underserved racial groups	Title I
No changes	21.1%	30.9%	1.1%	21.5%	No
Options A and B	19.3%	29.4%	1.3%	22.3%	No